



Q-sound
Bluetooth solar-powered headphones for the deep ecology gadget freak



2GB Micro SD
Apacer has unveiled high capacity Micro-SD cards in 2GB and 1GB capacities



iPWR
The iPWR juices up your iPod or iPhone when the battery drains out

Tomorrow's Tech

This may lead you to wonder, how exactly will open standards help?

Why so open?

Having grown up surrounded by the mantra of the three Rs (Reduce Reuse Recycle), it seems odd that precious few devices are built around that concept: "Why can't I reuse my Sony mobile headphones with my new Nokia mobile? Despite the fact that almost all these phones now use Lithium Ion cells, why can't I put a Motorola battery in a Samsung phone? Or even use the same charger?"

Even in their most forgiving of moods we are treated like little kids by manufacturers; no options offered, with the assumption that we are too dumb to know what we would want if given freedom and choice.

Open standards means that anyone is free to implement them. Which means that every manufacturer which makes a charger, or a battery, or even a screen will have to comply with the same standard. Right now it is possible to get only unbranded third-party replacement parts, with fuzzy warranties and little or no reliability. With open standards even some of the smaller companies can start making components and parts for a mobile device.

Why can't we reuse our Sony mobile headphones with our new Nokia phone? Why can't we put a Motorola battery in a Samsung phone? Or even use the same charger?

The UDPMD is completely open, so anyone and everyone can make modules for it. The word standard is as important, because without standardization every manufacturer would start manufacturing their own custom versions and we'll end up in the same place we are now. With the UDPMD you can go to just any mobile store and buy a charger of any company and be sure that it'll work, you can buy any headphone or any battery. The true competition then would be about who makes a better component, not which device do we have to compromise the least with.

With a device as modular and open as the UDPMD, customization becomes easy and you no longer have to adapt to the device, but the device will adapt to you!

What's that module?

All portable devices have some sort of micro-controller which will perform most of the processing involved. A micro-controller is

NOKIA MORPH

If you were thinking that we went over the top with the UDPMD, take a look at the Nokia Morph concept.

They envision a device created from materials which can morph into different shapes depending on what purpose they are being used for at the moment.

This beautiful device can fold itself

essentially a small computer on a single chip, yet all this potential goes to waste as you are locked down to the features of the gadget you bought and the interface it comes with.

Any portable media player today should be able to play Matroska (a lesser known audio / video file format) files, the processor is capable, just not programmed to allow for it since it does not have a large enough user base. This is understandable, yet with an open system, the open source (or otherwise) developer can pick up the slack and add the functionality themselves.

This is true for hardware as well. When you buy a mobile, for example, you often pick the model in which you have to make the least compromises. Why should we need to make compromises? If the iPhone has an amazing touch screen, but you like Android OS, and love the cameras that Nokia mobiles have, you will have to pick based on what you are most willing to forgo.

This is especially cruel of the manufacturers since mostly, the incompatibility is created by them. If the technology exists, why shouldn't you have the best of all? Due to artificial restrictions we are unable to optimally use our favorite devices to the best they are capable of.

The UDPMD will suffer from no such birth defects. With open hardware specifications that allow for modules, we can have easily have a device which uses the best from each field. Each component is separately installable and upgradeable.

You can remove that old 2MP camera and place in a brand new 5MP one without needing to chuck away the whole device.

You can mix and match

for better pocket-ability, and unfurl into a landscape view so you can read your documents better.

The surface is nanostructured, and it can be made self-cleaning, self-preserving and solar-powered!

Plays right into our UDPMD plan doesn't it?!

your own configuration, much as you can do today with assembled computers. Take the basic processing module, throw in a camera module, add a simple GPS module, and some kind of storage, install software that is capable of utilizing them, and voila! You have your own digital camera. Add a GSM module and you have your own mobile camera phone with GPS! You can even install a hub to extend the number of modules you can use at a time. What's more you can add an additional GSM module to allow the same device to use two connections.

The possibilities are now endless. You can go for the best manufacturer for each component without compromising on the other. Or, since money is always the final hurdle, you need only compromise with that which is least essential. Or if you can't be bothered with all this and prefer the *they-give-I-take* system you can buy ready made configured devices, and if someday you want to upgrade that lousy 40MB internal memory with a 160GB HDD, that path is always open to you! Oh and did we mention open standards? That means you can reuse the same modules for your next mobile.

Recycling: Mother Earth Approved

Many devices have a microphone for recording, or a speaker for playing sounds, and a screen for displaying visuals. Why can't we reduce the number of repeated modules by reusing the common features, thus recycling the resources?

With the UDPMD everything is a module, so you can go ahead and use that amazing expensive camera module you bought while making a digicam, with your new and awesome

